How Much of Mom's Financial Picture Do You Have So Far?

Twelve quick questions about what you know and have in hand. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and who to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and nothing here says what she may qualify for or how long her money may last.

1. Do you know every source of Mom's monthly income: Social Security, a pension, an annuity, anything else?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you have something in writing that shows each income amount, such as a benefit letter or a bank statement?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which banks or credit unions Mom has accounts with, and do you have a recent statement for each account?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know whether she has investment, brokerage or retirement accounts, and where they are held?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know whether she has life insurance, an annuity or long-term care insurance, and do you have the policies?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know what real estate, vehicles and other significant property she owns?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. For each account, policy and property, do you know whose name is on it and how it is titled?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Do you have the latest bill or rate sheet from the facility or care provider, and do you know what the monthly charge covers?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you written down what else Mom pays and owes each month: housing, utilities, insurance premiums, loans, credit cards?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you looked through her recent statements for unusual withdrawals, gifts or transfers, and written down any you found?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Are the statements, policies and bills you've found together in one place?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. For each open question, do you know who you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not what Mom has. A low count means there are things still to find, and most of them are a drawer, an envelope or a phone call away. It doesn't add anything up or say what any of it means for paying for her care. Rules vary by state, nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice, and those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what you know and what's still missing. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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